

Standard Operating Procedure

Verbal Order Process

«Hospital Name» — Supports MOM.4.f (CORE, Stop-Work)

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date		Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» takes, confirms, and countersigns a verbal medication order safely, limiting it to genuine situations and approved medications.

2. Scope

Applies to every verbal medication order given anywhere in the hospital.

3. Responsibility

Ordering Doctor: gives the verbal order and countersigns it in writing within 24 hours.

Receiving Nurse: reads back the order before acting on it and documents the read-back.

4. Procedure

1. Confirm the medication is on the hospital's approved verbal-order list before accepting a verbal order for it — medications not on the list are never accepted verbally.
2. The receiving nurse reads the order back to the ordering doctor in full — drug, dose, route, frequency — before acting on it.
3. Document the verbal order, the read-back confirmation, and the time, in the patient record immediately.
4. The ordering doctor countersigns the verbal order in writing within 24 hours — this is a hard deadline, not a target.
5. If 24 hours pass without countersignature, the nurse in charge escalates to the department head the same day.

5. Stop-Work Authority

Do not accept a verbal order for a medication that is not on the approved verbal-order list, except in a genuine life-threatening emergency, documented as such immediately afterward.

Do not act on a verbal order without completing the read-back — the nurse repeats the order back before administering it, every time.

Raising a missed read-back or an overdue countersignature is never a disciplinary matter.

6. Records

Supported by Record 7 of the MOM.4 Required Records pack: Verbal Order Log.

7. Related Documents

- Policy on Safe and Rational Prescription of Medications (HCO/MOM/POL/04) — MOM.4 policy

8. Review

Reviewed annually, and immediately after any verbal-order-related adverse event or countersignature failure.